Erasmia Gorla Raphael
Ph.D. Candidate, CUNY Graduate Center

Education

Ph.D. in Comparative Literature, The Graduate Center, CUNY (in progress)
M.A. in Comparative Literature, The Graduate Center, CUNY (2025)
M.S.Ed. in English Education, Lehman College, CUNY (2018)
B.A. in Comparative Literature, Barnard College, Columbia University, *cum laude* (2016)

Dissertation

Unburied: Necrospectacle Across a Tragedy-Horror Continuum
This dissertation advances the concept of necrospectacle to describe how tragedy and horror function as aesthetic death rituals that mediate encounters between audiences and the dead. Moving across a genre continuum that spans Classical Athenian tragedy, Japanese Nō theater, Early Modern English drama, and modern transnational horror film, the dissertation argues that tragedy and horror transform the unburied dead into objects of communal contemplation, allowing spectators to linger at the unstable boundaries of the self and confront the otherwise unassimilable knowledge of their own mortality.

Awards and Fellowships

Dissertation Year Fellowship, The Graduate Center, CUNY (2026–27)
Doctoral Tuition Fellowship, The Graduate Center, CUNY (2020–2026)
Bear Pin Award, Barnard College, Columbia University (2016)
Millicent McIntosh Award, Barnard College, Columbia University (2015)

Teaching Experience

Senior Thesis Advisor, BASIS Independent Brooklyn (Spring 2026)

- Advised a student through the development, research, writing, revision, and presentation of an independent senior thesis project on Euripidean tragedy and contemporary horror.

Adjunct Instructor, English Department, Bergen Community College (Fall 2024)

- Designed and taught a Foundational Writing course to first-year college students.

English Teacher, HERO High School (2016–2024)

- Designed and taught college-ready English courses for eleventh-grade (2022–24) and ninth-grade (2016–2022) students.
- Received Highly Effective teacher ratings (2018–2024).
- Served as English Department Chair (2022–24), Model Teacher (2021–24), and Grade Team Lead (2021-24).
- Directed the school’s annual Shakespeare Festival (2016–2022).

Conference Papers
"The Body in Pieces in Shakespeare's *Titus Andronicus*." Paper in panel "The Dismembered Body in the Early Modern World," Renaissance Association of America, forthcoming March 2027.

"From Ritual to Revenge: Maternal Grief-Work in Euripides' *Suppliants* and *Hecuba*." Paper in panel "Female Grief in Literature and the Arts," Northeast Modern Language Association, forthcoming March 2027.

"Necrospectacle Across the Tragedy-Horror Continuum." Paper in panel "Horror in Tragedy / Tragedy in Horror," Northeast Modern Language Association, forthcoming March 2027.

Conference Service
Organizer and Chair, "Horror in Tragedy / Tragedy in Horror," Northeast Modern Language Association, forthcoming March 2027.

Languages
English, Italian, French, Ancient Greek, Spanish

Professional Memberships
Northeast Modern Language Association
American Comparative Literature Association
Renaissance Society of America